

RealEquityIQ Journey Map – Experience Design Brief

Project Vision

RealEquityIQ is not intended to feel like a financial calculator.

The experience should feel more like a guided journey through important life decisions, where the user is accompanied by a knowledgeable guide and can visually see their progress, decisions, and outcomes over time.

The Journey Map is the central experience of the platform. Users are not simply entering data—they are moving through a personalized wealth-building journey.

Core Design Goal

Create a visual experience that feels like:

- A guided adventure
- A living roadmap
- A progress journey
- A decision story unfolding over time

Avoid:

- Spreadsheet aesthetics
- Traditional financial dashboards
- Static flowcharts
- Corporate process diagrams

The experience should feel closer to a modern game progression map than a financial planning application.

Journey Structure

The platform contains two connected journeys.

1. Wealth Discovery Journey

Purpose: Help users discover which housing path is projected to create the greatest long-term wealth.

Characteristics:

- Short duration experience
- Completed in approximately 10–15 minutes
- Guided and narrated
- Decision-focused
- Highly interactive
- Produces moments of surprise and insight

Typical flow:

1. Select location
2. Enter financial profile
3. Choose scenarios to compare
4. Predict which path will win
5. Reveal results
6. Explain outcome
7. Present recommended path

The journey ends at a fork:

- Explore another scenario
- Share results
- Connect with an advisor
- Begin execution

2. Wealth Execution Journey

Purpose: Help users accomplish the path they selected.

Characteristics:

- Long-term engagement
- Weeks, months, or years
- Progress-based
- Milestone driven
- Narrated
- Returns users to the platform repeatedly

Example milestones:

- Improve Credit
- Save Down Payment
- Meet Agent
- Get Pre-Approved
- Tour Homes

- Submit Offer
- Close on Home

This journey should feel like continuous advancement toward a meaningful goal.

Journey Map Philosophy

The map is not a separate reporting screen.

The map IS the experience.

Users should feel like they are always standing somewhere on the path.

Every action, simulation, milestone, and achievement advances them forward.

The visual language should reinforce:

"I am progressing."

rather than:

"I am viewing data."

Map Structure

The map is a continuous path containing nodes.

Each node represents:

- A simulation
- A decision point
- A milestone
- A completed achievement

The path should visually communicate:

- Past progress
- Current location
- Future opportunities

The map should naturally encourage users to continue moving forward.

Discovery Journey Map

Nodes represent simulation runs.

Each simulation becomes a point on the user's history.

The map should show:

- Order of simulations
- Branching decisions
- Wealth outcomes
- Evolution of thinking

Potential visual indicators:

- Net worth changes
- Better outcomes
- Alternate branches
- Favorite scenarios
- Saved scenarios

Users should be able to revisit any previous node.

Execution Journey Map

Nodes represent real-world milestones.

Example:

Start ↓ Improve Credit ↓ Save Down Payment ↓ Pre-Approval ↓ Tour Homes ↓ Offer Accepted ↓ Closing Day

The map should clearly indicate:

- Completed milestones
- Active milestone
- Upcoming milestones

Users should always know:

"What do I do next?"

Map-to-Environment Relationship

This relationship is critical.

The Map

The map is the permanent layer.

It provides:

- Context
- Direction
- Progress
- Continuity

The user always returns to the map.

Environment Scene

Each milestone opens an immersive environment.

Think of the environment as:

"A place on the journey."

Examples:

Pre-Approval Scene

- Lender office
- Mortgage desk
- Financial preparation

Tour Homes Scene

- Neighborhood street
- Open house
- Property comparison

Offer Scene

- Negotiation table
- Contract review

The environment is where milestone activities occur.

Zoom Pattern

The experience follows a repeating rhythm:

Map → Open Milestone → Environment Scene → Complete Activities → Return to Map → Advance Forward

This pattern should feel natural and repeatable throughout the entire execution journey.

Narration Experience

The platform includes a voice guide.

The voice should feel like:

- Coach
- Mentor
- Trusted advisor

Not:

- GPS navigation
- Corporate training
- Virtual assistant

Narration introduces:

- Screens
- Milestones
- Environment scenes
- Progress moments
- Achievement moments

The voice serves as the companion throughout both journeys.

Gamification Elements

The journey should support:

- Visible progression
- Completion recognition
- Milestone celebrations

- Journey history
- Achievement tracking
- Returning engagement

The goal is meaningful progress, not arcade-style rewards.

Avoid:

- Excessive badges
- Cartoon game mechanics
- Artificial point systems

Focus on accomplishment and momentum.

Emotional Design Goals

The user should feel:

Beginning:

- Curious
- Hopeful

Discovery:

- Surprised
- Enlightened

Execution:

- Supported
- Motivated

Progress:

- Accomplished
- Empowered

Completion:

- Successful
 - Confident
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Future Expansion Considerations

The design should allow future addition of:

- Richer environment scenes
- Animated progression
- Character/avatar movement
- Additional journey types
- New milestone categories
- Shared journey collaboration
- Advisor participation
- Partner participation

The journey map should be designed as a scalable platform feature rather than a fixed workflow.